

Rules for Indicators (in Transfer Matrix):

- Indicators cannot have “should” or “shall” in them, **unless** it is Indicator 2.1
- Indicators cannot have spelling or grammar mistakes
- Any indicator that differs from the IGI indicator in any way must be accompanied by justification
- Indicators that are the same as the IGI should be flagged as “adopted”
- Indicators that are different than the IGI should be flagged as “adapted”
- All indicators that are not in the IGIs but are in the text should be flagged as “new”
- All indicators that are in the IGIs but are not in the text should be flagged as “dropped”

More Rules for Indicators (Formulation)

The certification body generic standard shall specify indicator(s) for every criterion in accordance to the requirements of this standard.

3.2 When an FSC Criterion includes several requirements, associated indicators shall be developed for each requirement.

3.3 Each indicator shall specify outcomes or levels (i.e. thresholds) of performance that are measurable during an evaluation.

NOTE: An indicator may specify as a requirement that a particular procedure has been defined and documented, but such a requirement shall then be accompanied by the further requirement for evidence of implementation and an indication of the expected outcome in the forest management unit.

NOTE: An indicator may be specified in terms of an aspect to be measured together with a number of different thresholds that are applicable in different geographical, tenure or social situations within the geographical scope of the standard (e.g. different thresholds may be defined depending on the size of the forest management unit, or on the intensity of management being carried out within the unit).

3.4 Indicators shall not be defined in terms of design or descriptive characteristics, and shall not favour a particular technology or patented item.

3.5 Indicators shall only include elements that contribute to the achievement of the objective of the applicable FSC Criterion.

3.6 The meaning of the indicators and the level of performance required to comply with the indicators should be clear to the reader.

3.7 Each indicator shall refer to a single aspect of performance to be evaluated.

3.8 Indicators should be free from subjective elements. The use of such phrases as “ordinarily”, “substantial”, “proactive”, “appropriate to”, “minimize”, “wherever possible”, “thorough” or “best available” should be avoided.

3.9 Indicators should be easy to measure at a reasonable cost.

3.10 The certification body generic standard shall be written using a clear and consistent vocabulary.

3.11 The certification body generic standard should include examples of means of verification for every indicator.

NOTE: Means of verification are not normative. They do not define thresholds for conformity, but indicate potential sources of information or evidence that an auditor may find useful in evaluating conformity, such as records, documents, field observations or interviews.

3.12 Indicators shall apply to all forests covered by the scope of the standard, including small or lower intensity managed forests, unless otherwise specified

Rules for Notes:

Notes cannot remove requirements of an indicator for certain Organizations. For example, they cannot use language like “this does not apply to small organizations” or similar.

They also cannot use language like “must”, “shall”, or “should”.